

Jack Cong

Senior HMI / UX Leader — Automotive · Smart Cabin · In-Vehicle Experience

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EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Senior HMI / UX design leader with 20+ years shaping and delivering automotive in-vehicle experiences from concept to mass production across multiple vehicle programs. Built and scaled digital design organizations (5 → 25 at Lucid; built BYTON's China design org in Nanjing and Beijing from the ground up, growing the global team to 40+), and led end-to-end HMI design and delivery across instrument cluster, infotainment, driver controls, ADAS HMI, design systems, and mobile platforms — for production vehicles at Lucid (Air, Gravity), BYTON (M-Byte), and Telenav OEM partnerships (Ford Sync 3, GM, Cadillac). CS-trained (M.S. & B.S. Computer Science), and recognized for translating complex automotive technology into intuitive user experiences — Lucid Air (2022 MotorTrend Car of the Year), Lucid LIVE ([2024 iF Gold Award](#)).

CORE COMPETENCIES

Leadership: Global Team Building (0 → 1), Design Operations, Strategic Roadmap Planning, Cross-Functional Stakeholder Alignment, Mentoring & Talent Growth, Resource Allocation.

HMI Domains: ADAS Driver-Facing HMI, Instrument Cluster, Map & Navigation, Infotainment, Information Architecture (IA), Driver Controls, Design Systems, Mobile App / Companion Experience, Smart Cabin / In-Vehicle Experience.

Expertise: Unreal Engine-based HMI Design Delivery, Software Defined Vehicles (SDV), HMI/UX Roadmapping & Cross-Functional Delivery, Driver-Vehicle Interaction Design, User Research.

Tools & Methods: Figma, Adobe Creative Suite, ProtoPie, React Native, **AI-assisted development (Claude Code, Codex, Cursor)**, Xcode, Agile / JIRA / Confluence, metrics-driven UX iteration.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Lucid Motors | Newark, CA

Senior Manager, Product Design | 09/2022 – 04/2026 **Head of User Experience** | 09/2020 – 09/2022

- **Built the Product Design Organization & Team Architecture (2020–2022):** Scaled UX from a 5-person group into a 25+ person multidisciplinary Product Design organization within 12 months. Architected the team structure across Product Design, User Research, Advanced Design, 3D / Motion Design, and Technical Support — building the leadership layer that carried through the Air launch and into Gravity and Mid-Size programs.
- **Established the Product Design Lifecycle & UX Program Coordination (2020–2022):** Defined and operationalized Lucid's product design lifecycle — concept exploration → design definition → design production → engineering handoff. Built out the UX Program Management function by adding a dedicated UX Program lead who ran the team's internal program coordination AND served as the bridge to Engineering and Vehicle Program organizations — ensuring UX timelines, scope, and quality gates stayed aligned with cross-functional schedules.
- **Re-Architected the Digital Platform from Single-Vehicle to Scalable (Air → Gravity Foundation, 2021–2022):** Studied Lucid Air's HMI framework end-to-end, identified scalability bottlenecks rooted in single-

vehicle assumptions, and led the redesign of Lucid's information architecture and design system into a multi-program scalable platform — converting an Air-centric architecture into the foundation supporting Gravity and future vehicle programs.

- **ADAS HMI Design (Lucid Air, 2020–2022):** Led the HMI design for Lucid Air's L2 ADAS driver-facing experience — partnering with the ADAS organization to translate product requirements into intuitive in-vehicle interactions (perception visualization on the Instrument Cluster, Driver Monitoring presentation, Takeover Request flows).
 - **3D / Unreal Engine HMI Design (Air → Gravity):** Led the design team delivering HMI visual experience, interaction logic, and 3D content assets for Lucid's transition to an Unreal Engine-based HMI platform — producing perception visualization, instrument cluster, and ADAS engagement surfaces in close partnership with the engineering team that owned the underlying platform architecture.
 - **Multi-Domain Design Leadership & Production Excellence (2022–2026):** Led design delivery across nine HMI domains owned by the Product Design organization — ADAS, System Framework, Driver Control, Map & Navigation, AI Voice Assistance, Safety & Security, Entertainment, Design System, and Mobile Experience. Co-developed the Lucid Air and Gravity steering-wheel digital UX (button placement, on-wheel ADAS interaction) with Interior Design, Hardware Engineering, Homologation, and the ADAS Product Owner. Led the Mid-Size (Earth) platform concept. Recognized with the 2024 iF Design Gold Award (Lucid LIVE) and 2022 MotorTrend Car of the Year (Lucid Air).
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BYTON | Santa Clara, CA & Nanjing / Beijing, China

Global Head / Director of Digital Product Design | 05/2018 – 08/2020

- **Foundational IA & 48-inch Shared Experience Display (SED):** Built the foundational Information Architecture for the revolutionary 48-inch SED — defining how high-density **navigation, media, driver information, and connected-vehicle services** would coexist across an unprecedented in-vehicle digital canvas.
 - **China Design Organization (0 → 1) + Global Scale to 40+:** Built BYTON's China design organization in Nanjing and Beijing from the ground up, growing the global multidisciplinary team (UX, Visual, Motion, Research) to 40+ across Silicon Valley, Nanjing, and Beijing — coordinating delivery across three time zones.
 - **Systems & Ecosystem Integration:** Directed the digital product architecture and global interaction patterns. Orchestrated deep integration with 3rd-party partners (Baidu, Ximalaya), transforming external services into a cohesive, native branded experience.
 - **Strategic Governance:** Partnered with C-level stakeholders and VPs of Software/Hardware to define product strategy, ensuring 100% design accuracy and safety compliance throughout the production cycle.
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Telenav | Sunnyvale, CA & China

Senior Manager, User Experience Design (Founding Designer) | 2003 – 2018

- **Automotive HMI Scale & Impact:** Directed HMI / driver-facing UX for **Ford Sync 3 and GM / Cadillac Info3 connected navigation systems** — early foundations for connected-vehicle and driver-assist navigation experiences. Managed products serving **20M+ subscription users** across AT&T, Sprint, and T-Mobile.
 - **Founding & Global Growth:** Joined as Founding Designer; architected the world's first mobile connected navigation system (v1.0). Starting in 2006, built the China UX organization from the ground up — establishing three design teams across **Shanghai, Beijing, and Xi'an (12 designers total)** — supporting 20+ product launches.
 - **Mobile Pioneer:** Led the high-stakes transition from PND to smartphone ecosystems (iOS, Android, BlackBerry), establishing the company's mobile market leadership.
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INNOVATION PROJECTS

LinkSteps — *Founder & Lead Developer* Architected and developed a React Native mobile application using AI-driven toolchains (Claude Code) to connect seniors with families through real-time health-data monitoring, focused on sensory protection and care-coordination.

EDUCATION

- **M.S., Computer Science** — Northwestern Polytechnic University, Fremont, CA (1999 – 2001)
- **B.S., Computer Science** — Beijing Institute of Business Administration, China (1987 – 1991)

AWARDS

- [2024 iF Design Gold Award](#) — Lucid In-Vehicle Experience (LIVE)
- **2022 MotorTrend Car of the Year** — Design Lead for Lucid Air